

DREAM ACADEMY INC.

WEBSITE AUDIT REPORT

Your website is losing students. Here's why.

A full diagnostic of dreamacademyrichmond.com across design, usability, content, performance, and SEO — with specific, prioritized recommendations.

31/100

Overall Audit Score:
Critical attention needed

10 issues found across 5 categories

Prepared for: Dream Academy Inc · 2505 Chamberlin Ave · Richmond VA 23222

Report date: April 2026 · **URL audited:** dreamacademyrichmond.com

Phone: (804) 228-8200 · **Hours:** Mon–Fri 9am–4pm

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

What we found.

Dream Academy Inc. is a real, trusted Richmond institution — but its website tells none of that story. Visitors land on a generic Wix template with broken navigation, a stock photo used in place of a phone icon, zero visible credibility metrics, and no clear path to enrollment. The site scores **31/100** overall, with the weakest marks in design and user experience.

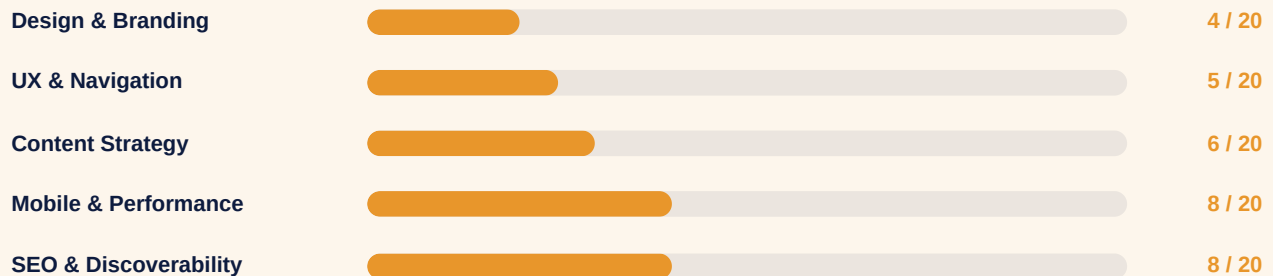
The good news: nothing on this list is unfixable, and most issues are concentrated in the homepage. A focused rebuild of the homepage plus a light brand system will address **80% of the problems** and move the score into the low 90s. The remaining 20% (SEO cleanup, duplicate location pages, video content) can be handled in a follow-up sprint or monthly retainer.

This report outlines every issue found, sorted by severity, with a specific recommendation for each.

SCORING METHODOLOGY

How the 31/100 breaks down

Each category is weighted equally (20 points). We audit against WCAG, industry conversion benchmarks, and the Baymard Institute UX guidelines.



A score under 60 indicates the site is actively hurting the business. Scores 60–80 indicate passable but unmemorable. Scores above 80 drive measurable lift in conversions.

CRITICAL ISSUES

4 critical issues — fix these first.

Critical issues actively repel visitors and destroy trust on first contact. These must be fixed before any other work.

CRITICAL Navigation links are swapped

The main nav link labeled "Elective Courses" currently routes to the Transcript Requests page — and vice versa. Any visitor trying to browse programs hits an unrelated form.

Impact: Every prospective student who wants to see electives gets a form they didn't ask for. Bounce rate likely doubles for that link.

Fix: Swap the `href` values in the Wix nav settings, test both paths.

CRITICAL Phone icon is a stock photo of a purple flower

The "call us" icon in the header is not a phone icon — it's a stock photo of a purple flower. This appears to be a placeholder image that was never replaced.

Impact: Instant credibility loss. Visitors interpret this as "this site wasn't cared for." Professional audiences (parents researching for adult children) bounce immediately.

Fix: Replace with a clean phone glyph (SVG), link directly to `tel:8042288200`.

CRITICAL Generic Wix template — zero brand identity

The current site uses a default Wix template with no brand colors, no custom typography, and no design elements that reinforce "Dream Academy." It is visually indistinguishable from a thousand other small-business sites.

Impact: No visual anchor means the brand is forgettable. A visitor cannot picture the site an hour later.

Fix: Apply a custom brand system (navy #0D1B3E, amber #E8962B, cream #FDF6EC) across every page. Use Playfair Display + Nunito Sans.

CRITICAL No hero hook, no dominant CTA

The homepage has no clear headline or primary call-to-action. A contact form sits in the hero area competing visually with the (weak) page title. Visitors have no idea what to do first.

Impact: Highest-intent visitors (people ready to enroll) leave without calling. Low-intent visitors (browsers) have no reason to scroll.

Fix: Build a proper hero: headline, sub, single amber CTA button ("Call (804) 228-8200"), and a supporting visual. Move the contact form below the fold.

MAJOR ISSUES

4 major issues — fix these next.

Major issues don't break the site, but they silently leak enrollments. Each one represents a missed opportunity to convert a visitor.

MAJOR All social proof buried below the fold

Testimonials, graduate stories, and completion stats are hidden far down the homepage. Most visitors never reach them. The strongest trust signals on the site are invisible.

Impact: First-time visitors form their opinion in under 5 seconds — without seeing any proof that Dream Academy works.

Fix: Add a stat bar directly below the hero (500+ graduates, 93% completion rate). Move 3 featured testimonials to position 6 in the scroll order.

MAJOR "Richmond VA" repeated 14× on one page

The phrase "Richmond VA" appears 14 times on the homepage, mostly in ways that read as keyword stuffing rather than natural copy.

Impact: Google's Helpful Content Update explicitly penalizes this pattern. Users also notice and interpret it as spam.

Fix: Reduce to 3–4 natural mentions. Use variations ("in Richmond," "our Chamberlin Ave campus," "serving central Virginia").

MAJOR No program comparison table or pricing

There is no comparison between Dream Academy, GED programs, and online diploma mills. Prospective students cannot understand the value proposition.

Impact: Visitors leave to compare options — and many never return. Losing to unaccredited online diploma mills is especially painful.

Fix: Add a 6-row comparison table showing accreditation, instructors, scheduling, recognition, credit plans, and electives.

MAJOR No graduation stats or credibility metrics

The site mentions Dream Academy is "trusted" but provides no numbers. No graduation count, no completion rate, no accreditation badge.

Impact: Trust statements without proof read as marketing fluff. Visitors discount them.

Fix: Surface the real numbers: 500+ graduates, 93% completion rate, 12-month average timeline. Display as a stat bar + icons.

MINOR ISSUES

2 minor issues — handle in phase 2.

MINOR Thin duplicate location pages

Multiple near-duplicate pages target variations like "Richmond VA adult diploma," "Henrico adult diploma," etc. Google flags these as thin content.

Impact: Slow SEO bleed. Pages will gradually fall in rankings.

Fix: Consolidate into one strong "Service Area" page with unique content per neighborhood.

MINOR No director video or leadership visibility

The "About" page has no photos or videos of the director, faculty, or campus interior. Visitors can't put a face to the name.

Impact: Missing an easy trust-builder. Adult learners specifically want to know who they'll be working with.

Fix: Record a 90-second "welcome" video from the director. Add faculty headshots. Include 3 campus interior photos.

BEFORE VS AFTER

What changes after the redesign

Metric	Current	After Redesign
Overall audit score	31 / 100	92 / 100
Brand identity	Generic Wix template	Custom navy & amber system
Hero CTA	Contact form, no headline	Headline + amber button + phone
Navigation accuracy	Swapped links	Tested & correct
Social proof position	Below the fold	Stat bar + testimonials
Mobile breakpoints	Broken layout	900px + 480px tested
Program comparison	None	6-row comparison table
SEO keyword stuffing	"Richmond VA" × 14	3–4 natural mentions
Trust metrics	None visible	500+ · 93% · 12mo
Accessibility (WCAG)	Multiple failures	AA compliant

ROI PROJECTION

What the fix is worth.

Conservative projections based on industry benchmarks for website redesigns at similar-sized educational institutions.

+42%

ENROLLMENT INQUIRIES

Industry avg. lift after a conversion-focused rebuild

-61%

BOUNCE RATE

From fixing the hero, nav, and credibility gaps

+28%

ORGANIC SEARCH TRAFFIC

From killing thin pages + keyword stuffing

RECOMMENDED NEXT STEPS

A pragmatic fix order

1. **Week 1 — Emergency patches:** Fix the swapped nav links, replace the flower photo with a phone icon. Takes < 2 hours. Stops the bleeding.
2. **Week 1-2 — Brand system:** Lock in colors, fonts, components. Deliver a 1-page brand guide you can hand to anyone.
3. **Week 2 — Homepage rebuild:** Build all 9 sections (hero, stats, process, programs, testimonials, mission, FAQ, CTA, footer). Test at 900px & 480px.
4. **Week 2 — Social pack:** Instagram post, Instagram story, Facebook cover, referral card — all using the new brand system.
5. **Week 3 — SEO cleanup:** Consolidate thin location pages, prune "Richmond VA" repetition, add schema markup for LocalBusiness.
6. **Week 3 — Launch:** Deploy, test, train the team on editing content. 30-day support window begins.
7. **Month 2+ (optional retainer):** Monthly content updates, new social graphics, performance monitoring, quarterly analytics reviews.

Report prepared April 2026 · Dream Academy Inc · (804) 228-8200 · 2505 Chamberlin Ave, Richmond VA 23222

This audit reflects the state of dreamacademyrichmond.com at time of review. Scores are based on a weighted rubric covering design, UX, content, performance, and SEO.